

Dear Members of the Admissions Committee,

I am pleased to write this letter in strong support of Hon Li's application to your graduate program in Data Analytics.

I have worked in the computer science and software engineering industry for more than twenty years. During that time, I have worked with and mentored many junior developers, interns, and early-career technical professionals. Based on that experience, I can say that Hon is one of the most serious, careful, and detail-oriented individuals I have mentored at his level.

I had the opportunity to mentor Hon during his internship, where we worked together on an internal company analytics project involving financial time-series data and strategy simulation. In my role as his mentor, I observed not only his technical work, but also the way he approached data, assumptions, and the correctness of analytical results.

The project focused on building an internal analytics prototype that transformed raw market data into structured event-level information. Instead of simply using closing prices, the system needed to consider how price movement within a bar could affect the sequence of generated events. This required Hon to think carefully about how raw data should be interpreted before it could be used for analysis.

What impressed me most was Hon's attention to correctness. He did not treat the project as a simple coding task where the goal was only to produce an output. He understood that in data analytics, an output is only meaningful if the underlying data transformation and calculation logic are reliable. He paid close attention to details such as event ordering, price precision, repeated triggers, transaction costs, and position-level calculations. These details directly affected whether the final analytical results could be trusted.

Hon was also methodical in solving problems. When something did not behave as expected, he did not make random changes just to get the code to run. He worked to understand the expected result, trace the source of the discrepancy, and verify the logic step by step. In our discussions, he asked thoughtful questions and was willing to revise his approach when a detail could affect the accuracy of the analysis.

Over the course of the internship, I saw Hon become more organized in handling complex technical and analytical problems. He improved in breaking down tasks, checking assumptions, and explaining the reasoning behind his implementation decisions. He was receptive to feedback and applied it seriously. This growth gave me confidence in his ability to succeed in a graduate-level Data Analytics program.

What I value most about Hon is his disciplined mindset. In my experience, successful analytics work requires more than familiarity with software tools. It requires patience, precision, and the ability to question whether the data and calculations actually support the conclusion. Hon demonstrated these qualities consistently during our work together.

Based on my direct experience mentoring him, I strongly recommend Hon Li for admission to your graduate program in Data Analytics. I believe he has the technical foundation, analytical discipline, and work ethic necessary to succeed in graduate study and to contribute positively to your academic community.

Sincerely,

Jianmin Zhu

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